PORTLAND | Public Schools

RIGHTSIZING

Superintendent's Recommendation Summary

Projected declines in student enrollment at Portland Public Schools, coupled with a looming $65 million budget deficit, require immediate action. The final recommendation proposes closing and consolidating 10 elementary schools, phased over two years. The proposal also includes changing several K-8 schools to K-5, moving Spanish Dual Language Immersion programs into four "hubs," and changing school boundaries to reflect the new configurations. These steps will provide more stability to the district and ensure all students receive the educational resources and supports they need to succeed.

The proposal contains notable changes from prior Scenarios A and B. It will close fewer schools, relocate less programs, and spread closures over two years. These changes were made after hearing concerns raised by students, families and other PPS communities. The proposal will now go to the Board of Education, which will continue gathering public input before voting on **December 15**.

CHANGES IN RESPONSE TO COMMUNITY FEEDBACK

- Sellwood Middle School, James John, Maplewood, and Stephenson will remain open.
- Sunnyside remains an environmental focus school, but converts to K-5.
- Skyline students will continue on to Lincoln High School rather than to Roosevelt.
- Odyssey K-8 choice program moves to Forest Park instead of Metropolitan Learning Center.
- The Mandarin DLI program currently housed at Dr. MLK Jr. remains at its current location.
- Lewis, Marysville, Woodmere, and Rose City Park will close in Fall 2028 instead of Fall 2027.

THE FOLLOWING CLOSURES AND CONSOLIDATIONS HELP ENSURE EACH SCHOOL IS FULLY ENROLLED WITH STABLE AND ADEQUATE RESOURCES.

This includes:

- Stable staffing, with qualified educators and specialists and fewer educators split across multiple buildings or roles.
- Rigorous, culturally responsive core academics and elective offerings, including arts, world language, physical education, athletics, interventions and acceleration.
- Safe, healthy, and comfortable facilities.

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Closures and consolidations

FALL 2027

- **Beach closes** and students move to Chief Joseph with a projected enrollment of 441. Beach students who wish to continue in Spanish DLI move to Cesar Chavez.
- **Peninsula closes** and students move to Rosa Parks with a projected enrollment of 481. Cesar Chavez English Scholar students also move to Rosa Parks.
- **Sabin closes** and students move to Dr. Martin Luther King Jr. with a projected enrollment of 424.
- **Creston closes** and students move to Atkinson with a projected enrollment of 474. Atkinson students who wish to continue in Spanish DLI move to Lent.
- Creston's **Deaf and Hard of Hearing students move to Glencoe** with a projected enrollment of 312.
- **Buckman closes** and students move to Abernethy and Sunnyside K-5 with projected enrollments of 312 and 480.
- **Beverly Cleary K-5 merges with Irvington** and remains at Irvington for one year while Beverly Cleary undergoes seismic reinforcement. The merger's projected enrollment is 502.
- **Scott students** who wish to continue in Spanish DLI move to Rigler.
- **Sitton students** who wish to continue in Spanish DLI move to Cesar Chavez.
- **Metropolitan Learning Center becomes a K-8** and grades 9-12 move to Alliance or their neighborhood high school.

Additionally, six K-8 schools (Beverly Cleary; Cesar Chavez; Faubion; Laurelhurst; Sunnyside; and Vernon) convert to K-5, with grades 6-8 moving to nearby middle schools.

FALL 2028

- **Rose City Park closes** and English Scholar students move to Scott with a projected enrollment of 489. Students who wish to continue in the Vietnamese DLI program move to Vestal.
- **Lewis closes** and students move to Duniway with a projected enrollment of 533.
- **Marysville closes** and students move to Arleta with a projected enrollment of 415.
- **Woodmere closes** and students move to Whitman with a projected enrollment of 444.
- Students enrolled in **Mandarin DLI at Clark** who wish to continue in this program **move to Woodstock**.
- **Beverly Cleary reopens** and the merged Beverly Cleary-Irvington relocates to Beverly Cleary with their classmates.

Additionally, one K-8 school (Bridger) converts to K-5, with grades 6-8 moving to nearby middle schools.

DUAL LANGUAGE IMMERSION (DLI)

- PPS is adopting a "hub" model for Spanish DLI to consolidate resources rather than have smaller programs spread around too many underenrolled schools.
- Spanish DLI will move from nine elementaries to one in each of four regions: Cesar Chavez, Rigler, Lent and Ainsworth. Buses will provide transportation to all DLI students from centralized locations.
- Mandarin DLI will consolidate from three pathways to two, one each in north and southeast Portland.
- Japanese, Russian and Vietnamese dual language immersion programs will remain open with each at one elementary.
- The total number of seats available in each Dual Language program will remain unchanged.

SPECIAL EDUCATION

- Currently students in special education focus classrooms are assigned to schools regionally. The intention is to move special education focus classes closer to where students live and keep them connected with their neighborhood peers.
- PPS will provide support specific to students' needs if they transition to a new school site due to school closure, program shifting, or boundary changes. Some students may require additional support from their IEP (Individual Education Plan) teams.

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